

vector editor (e.g. Illustrator). Converting a vector image to bitmap is quite simple but the other way around is a whole different ball game.

Proprietary software

Adobe Illustrator

Adobe released its very first application in 1987, Illustrator for Macintosh. Version 2.0 for Windows was released in 1989 and now at version 16.0, Illustrator has established itself as the reigning vector editing program on the market, trumping applications like CorelDraw which was the market leader at the time.

At its price tag, Adobe Illustrator makes for an expensive buy. But to be fair, it is the culmination of years of research and improvement. Illustrator is now the industry standard application in 2D vector graphics editing and design.

CorelDraw X7

The closest Illustrator competitor in the paid space has an admirable customizable workspace. Released in 1989, it dominated the vector graphics editor market (and then of course Illustrator took the lead). Meant for Windows, it is available for around 299\$ on Amazon. The Corel website says, “If you can dream it, you can design it.” Apart from a commendable catch phrase, Corel does offer a huge array of tutorials to help you along. CorelDraw has a clean user interface with some raster based effects thrown in.

Xara Designer Pro X10

This graphic designer is what you would get if you combined Illustrator, Photoshop and InDesign, then roll it into one fast program. The user interface has certain very intuitive characteristics, for example, if you click on most tools, the info bar will automatically show you the description of that tool. A feature that stands out is the numerous and very usable templates that you can dismember and re-assemble however you want. Its non-destructive editing means that you can't really mess up anything. Available only for Windows, Xara Designer Pro X can be bought through a perpetual license for 299\$.

Affinity Designer

After four years of development, Affinity design was finally released last August. What's new is that it is a high-end product created especially for